

Asus W1S00

The Asus W1S00 laptop is the first laptop featuring a TV-Tuner to have arrived at our Test Centre. Specifications include an Intel Pentium M 1700 MHz processor, 512 MB of RAM, a 60 GB hard drive, and a Combo drive. The vibrant 15.4-inch 16:9 wide screen has a WXGA+ resolution of 1680 x 1050 and good viewing angles. The 64 MB ATi Mobility Radeon 9700 graphics card makes for a good gaming laptop.

Almost all the connections are on the left - USB 2.0, LAN, phone jack, PCMCIA, FireWire, and the input to the TV-Tuner. There's also a multi-card reader that reads SD/MMC/MS/MS Pro cards, as well as Wi-Fi and IR. The remote control is tucked inside the PCMCIA slot, where its Li-Ion battery charges; it can be pulled out when needed. The remote works with the bundled Asus Mobile Theatre, a

media centre application.

The sound system consists of two speakers and a subwoofer hidden on the bottom surface. The bundled

earphones help realise the 4.1 sound mode, and the sound quality is commendably good for a laptop. However, the W1S00 is below par when it comes to office applications, and battery life is a relatively low 85 minutes.

Company **ASUS Tek Computer Inc.**

Price **Rs 1,25,000 + taxes**

Phone **022-56290787**

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Web site **www.asus.com.tw**

Rating 

Logitech G15 Keyboard

Play Away!

Logitech's G15 keyboard is targeted at gamers. It's wider than most other keyboards, and the wrist rest offers good support. There are two USB ports on the front, and it has a controllable blue backlight.

The G15 has 18 programmable keys, each of which have three modes. The accompanying macro profiling application lets you assign a particular combination of keys to a single such key. These keys can really help RTS and MMORPG players. Recording macros is simple, and Logitech has provided profiles for most new games.

Of particular interest is the new LCD display, which isn't just a display—it's a platform Logitech is trying to push. If game developers take to it, game statistics such as ammo and life will be displayed on the screen. For now, Logitech has included an LCD clock, a performance monitor and a media display (for WinAmp, iTunes and WMP info) for the LCD.

At Rs 5,000, this keyboard is worth the money if you're an avid MMORPG or RTS gamer.



Company **Logitech Electronic India Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 4,995**

Phone **022-26571160**

E-mail **response@logitech.com**

Web site **www.logitech.com**

Rating 

Logitech G5 Laser Mouse

Game for more?

Part of the gaming series from Logitech, the G5 is a corded laser mouse sporting Logitech's new colour combination—a mixture of brick-red, silver and smoke black. The rugged feel and rough texture makes for perfect grip. The mouse is designed to neatly fit into the palm of a right-hander, with a nice groove on the left for the thumb—but we do think it may be a little too big for those with smaller palms.

The G5 is very light, and speaking of weight, it comes with eight little weights—of 4.5 gm and 1.7 gm—which you can add to a small removable tray at the base to attain the right weight for your gaming comfort!

Installing drivers for the mouse is not essential, as almost all the buttons function as they should even without driver installation. If you install the drivers, a lot of features can be controlled via the Logitech SetPoint utility that comes with the drivers.

Apart from the usual buttons, the scroll wheel can also be used as a button—you could, for instance, use the button to enable page zooming, and then move the scroll up or

down to zoom in or out respectively. There's also a button just above the thumb groove—we wish there were two! Two buttons would not only enhance Web site navigation, but could also be configured for various gaming actions.



The mouse sensitivity can be increased or decreased on the fly using two tiny buttons just below the scroll. Higher sensitivity suits fast FPS games such as *Unreal Tournament*, and decreasing the sensitivity while using a sniper will bag more 'head shots.' The sensitivity presets are 400 dpi, 800 dpi, and a max of 2,000 dpi. But using the SetPoint utility that the driver installs, you can change the sensitivity settings. You can add two user-defined sensitivity levels in between 400 to 800 dpi and 800 to 2,000 dpi.

The G5 scores high for the level of customisation it provides, but at the end of the day, it is an expensive mouse.

Company **Logitech Electronic India Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 4,450**

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Rating 